Question Stem Cards

Level 1: gathering (on the page) · Level 2: processing (between the lines) · Level 3: applying (off the page)

Any subject

Level 1

- What do you know about your problem?
- What does ___ mean?
- What did you write in your class notes about this?
- What does the textbook say about this topic?
- What is the question asking you to find?
- Is there a formula, rule, or memory trick (like PEMDAS) that fits this problem?

Level 2

- Can you break this problem into smaller parts? What are they?
- How can you organize this information?
- What can you infer from what you read?
- Is there a similar example in your notes or textbook?
- What is the relationship between ___ and ___?
- What have you already tried? Where did it stop working?
- How are ___ and ___ similar? How are they different?

Level 3

- How do you know your answer is correct? How could you check it?
- Is there more than one way to solve this?
- Could there be another correct answer?
- Can you explain it in a different way?
- Where could you use this in real life?
- Would this method work on other problems? Which ones?
- What would happen if you changed ___?

Math

Level 1

- What information is given in the problem?
- What are you being asked to find?
- What formula would you use?
- What does ___ mean?
- What math concept does this connect to?
- Can you draw a diagram of it?

Level 2

- What other information do you need to solve this?
- How could you show the data as a graph or table?
- What equation could you write for the word problem?
- Explain how you calculated that.
- Does that step make sense? Why?
- Compare this problem to the example in your notes. What is the same?

Level 3

- How can you tell if your answer is reasonable?
- Plug your answer back in. Does it work?
- What would happen if ___ increased or decreased?
- Predict what happens to ___ as ___ changes.
- Using a math rule, how could we find ___ another way?
- Make up a problem like this one for the group.

Science

Level 1

- What information is provided?
- What are you being asked to find?
- What does ___ mean?
- Which formula or law applies?
- Can you draw a diagram of the process?
- What science concept does this connect to?

Level 2

- How could you show the data in a graph?
- Compare and contrast ___ and ___.
- What errors could have affected the results?
- How do the results support (or not support) the hypothesis?
- What evidence supports your explanation?
- What method would you use to ___?

Level 3

- Predict what will happen to ___ if ___ changes.
- What would happen if this variable increased or decreased?
- How would repeated trials affect the data?
- Design a lab to test ___.
- Are the results biased? How could you tell?
- Why does this experiment matter for what you are learning?

English

Level 1

- What information does the text give?
- Where in the text does it say ___?
- Who are the main characters?
- When and where does it take place?
- What does this word mean in this sentence?
- What events led to ___?

Level 2

- What is the main idea or theme?
- What evidence supports your explanation?
- What does ___ suggest about the character?
- Compare and contrast ___ and ___.
- What is the author trying to prove or show?
- What other ways could this be interpreted?

Level 3

- What do you predict will happen? Why?
- Could this story really happen? Why or why not?
- Rewrite this part from another character's point of view.
- What is most convincing to you in this text? Why?
- If you were there, what would you do?
- How does this connect to your life or the world?

History / Social Studies

Level 1

- What information is provided?
- When did the event take place?
- Who were the people involved?
- Where did it happen?
- What is the definition of ___?
- Can you put the events in order on a timeline?

Level 2

- What was the cause? What was the effect?
- What is the main idea of this source?
- Compare and contrast ___ and ___.
- What information supports your explanation?
- What would you have done in that situation?
- What other ways could this event be interpreted?

Level 3

- What would have happened if ___?
- Was ___ fair or ethical? Why or why not?
- Why is this event significant today?
- What do you think will happen next? Why?
- How can you tell if your analysis is reasonable?
- What would it have been like to live then?